

MUSIC CUE SHEET GENERATOR

User Guide



What it does

Music Cue Sheet Generator turns a Pro Tools session file into a music cue sheet without opening Pro Tools. Right-click a .ptx file in Finder, pick the tracks you want included, and the app produces a branded PDF and CSV cue sheet next to the session file.

Cue sheets are merged, deduplicated and grouped automatically — crossfaded clips, stereo L/R pairs, and adjacent edits of the same clip are consolidated into single cues. Stem groups (multi-track musical works playing simultaneously) are detected and combined under their shared name.

Requirements

A Mac with Apple Silicon (M1 or later) running macOS Sequoia or later. You do not need Python, Pro Tools, or any other tools installed — everything is bundled inside the app.

Installation

1. **Unzip** the file you were sent. You should see `Music Cue Sheet.app`.
2. **Drag** `Music Cue Sheet.app` into your `/Applications` folder.
3. **First launch — important:** macOS will block the app the first time you run it because it isn't signed by an Apple developer. This is expected. To allow it:
 1. Try to open the app once. macOS will show a warning saying the app cannot be opened.
 2. Open **System Settings** → **Privacy & Security**.
 3. Scroll down to the **Security** section. You will see "Music Cue Sheet was blocked..." with an **Open Anyway** button next to it.
 4. Click **Open Anyway** and confirm with Touch ID or your password.
 5. The app will then run normally from now on, no further prompts.

Faster alternative for Terminal users:

```
xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine "/Applications/Music Cue Sheet.app"
```

Setting up the right-click

To make the app appear in the right-click menu when you click a `.ptx` file, you need to create a Quick Action in Automator. You only do this once.

Step-by-step

1. Open **Automator** (Applications → Automator). Choose **New Document**, then select **Quick Action** as the document type.
2. At the top of the Automator window, configure:
Workflow receives current → **files or folders**
in → **Finder**
3. In the actions list on the left, find **Run Shell Script** (under Utilities). Drag it into the empty workflow area on the right.
4. In the Run Shell Script settings: set **Shell** to `/bin/bash`, and **Pass input to as arguments**.
5. Replace the contents of the script box with:

```
open -a "/Applications/Music Cue Sheet.app" --args "$1"
```
6. Save the Quick Action. Name it **Music Cue Sheet** when prompted.

The action is now installed. When you right-click a `.ptx` file in Finder, choose **Quick Actions** → **Music Cue Sheet** and the app will launch.

Using it

1. **Right-click** any `.ptx` file in Finder and choose **Quick Actions** → **Music Cue Sheet**.
2. A browser window opens showing every track in the session, organised into folders. Tracks with audio clips have a counter next to them.
3. Tick the boxes next to the tracks you want included in the cue sheet. For most music cue sheets this means your MX (music) tracks — though pick whatever applies to the session.
4. Click the **Export Session Info as Text...** button at the bottom right of the window.
5. The button label changes to *Generating...* while the cue sheet builds. It takes a couple of seconds for typical sessions.
6. When done, the button shows a tick and the browser tab closes. Two new files appear in the same folder as the `.ptx`:
 - `<session name> Cuesheet.pdf` — branded cue sheet ready for delivery
 - `<session name> Cuesheet.csv` — raw cue data for spreadsheet use

Troubleshooting

Right-click menu does not show "Music Cue Sheet"

Open System Settings → Keyboard → Keyboard Shortcuts → Services → Files and Folders. Make sure "Music Cue Sheet" is ticked. If you do not see it there, the Quick Action was not saved correctly — repeat the setup steps.

The browser opens but no tracks appear

The session may use a Pro Tools format the parser does not yet recognise, or the session file might be from a much older Pro Tools version. Try with a different session to confirm.

Clicking "Export Session Info as Text..." produces no cue sheet

A pop-up should appear with the specific error. Most common cause is no tracks ticked — make sure at least one track with clips is selected.

The cue sheet appears but seems wrong

Open the CSV file alongside the PDF. The CSV contains the raw clip data before any merging or grouping. If the CSV is correct but the PDF looks odd, the grouping logic combined something it should not have. Send both files to your studio contact.

App does not open at all

Make sure you completed the first-launch security bypass (see Installation, step 3). If you skipped that step, the app will appear to do nothing when you launch it.

Cue sheet generates but the file names look wrong

The cue sheet always takes its name from the .ptx file. Rename the .ptx before running if you want different output names.

Support

If something is not working and the troubleshooting above does not help, contact Paul at Mighty Sound. Include:

- A brief description of what went wrong
- The name of the .ptx session you were processing
- Any error pop-up messages that appeared
- Whether the cue sheet was partially produced (CSV but no PDF, etc.)